

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

SDLC Cheat Sheet

The Software Development Life Cycle at a glance — and where testing fits.

Introduction

The SDLC is the process of building software from idea to live product. Testing belongs in every phase, not just at the end.

The Phases

Phase	What happens	Tester contribution
Requirements	Define what to build and why	Review for clarity, gaps, testability
Design	Decide how it will work	Ask "how will we test this?"
Development	Build the software	Unit/component checks; early collaboration
Testing	Verify the software	System, integration, regression testing
Deployment	Release to environments	Smoke test; release readiness
Maintenance	Support and improve	Re-test fixes; guard against regressions

Waterfall vs Agile

- Waterfall: phases run once, in sequence.
- Agile: phases repeat in short iterations with continuous testing.

Common Mistakes

- Believing testing is a single phase at the end.
- Ignoring requirements quality, then testing against a vague spec.
- Thinking agile means no process or documentation.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

"Shift left" simply means start testing thinking at the requirements stage — the earlier you are involved, the cheaper quality becomes.